

Kevin Mi

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Michigan State University, expected May 2027
M.A. Economics, Michigan State University, 2024
B.Sc. Mathematics, University of Maryland, College Park, 2022
B.Sc. Economics, University of Maryland, College Park, 2022

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomic Theory
Subfields: Platform Economics, Digital Economics, Antitrust Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

“AI Search Features and Quality Degradation”

Abstract: Search platforms, such as Google and Bing, increasingly answer queries with artificial intelligence (AI) search features that scrape and synthesize content from online publishers. In this paper, I develop a theoretical model to examine how the introduction of AI search features affects content investment decisions, platform design choices, and welfare. Improvement in AI content quality enhances users' direct benefit from the search platform but can also divert users away from publishers' sites. Consequently, it erodes the publishers' incentives to invest in high-quality content and, in turn, reduces the quality of the AI content. In the face of this tradeoff, I show that introducing an AI search feature improves user surplus but may reduce social welfare if publishers sufficiently value user clicks. Furthermore, I analyze how this tradeoff shapes the platform's choice of AI search quality. Finally, I apply the model to evaluate several proposed policies for regulating AI search features. I find that copyright restrictions can implement the socially optimal outcome; platform competition and pay-per-crawl payments may reduce social welfare; opt-out options have ambiguous effects on welfare; and licensing deals can improve welfare, although the optimal form of licensing depends on market conditions.

WORKING PAPERS

“Artificial Intelligence and the Brain: Is Innovation Getting Easier?” (with Danxia Xie, Buyuan Yang, and Hanzhe Zhang)
“Join or Wait? Seller Capability Development and Dynamic Platform Pricing” (with Danxia Xie, Buyuan Yang, and Hanzhe Zhang)
“Data Sharing and Collusion on Hybrid Platforms”
“Price Chokeholds with Minimum Margin Agreements”

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Algorithmic Collusion under Multimarket Contact” (with Abhishek Ray)

MISCELLANEOUS PAPERS

“Aggregate and analysis of secondary pharmacology data from investigational new drug submissions at the US Food and Drug Administration,” **Journal of Pharmacological and Toxicological Methods**, September 2021, Vol. 111 (with Andrew Dodson, Daniel P. Russo, Christina Scott, Muriel Salmier, Kevin Snyder, and Rebecca Racz).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, EC201 Introduction to Microeconomics, Summer 2024
Teaching Assistant (Graduate), EC812A Microeconomics I and its Mathematical Foundations, Fall 2023 and Fall 2024
Teaching Assistant (Graduate), EC812B Microeconomics II, Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant, EC499 Senior Seminar: Economics of Platform Markets, Fall 2025
Teaching Assistant, EC401 Advanced Microeconomics, Fall 2025 and Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant, EC360 Private Enterprise and Public Policy, Spring 2024
Teaching Assistant, EC302 Intermediate Macroeconomics, Fall 2022
Teaching Assistant, EC301 Intermediate Microeconomics, Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant, EC201 Introduction to Microeconomics, Spring 2025 and Spring 2026
Graduate Student Tutor for First Year Microeconomics Qualifying Examinations, 2025

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Economics Intern, Office of Economics and Analysis, Food and Drug Administration, 2021-2022
Pathways Program Intern, Office of New Drugs, Food and Drug Administration, 2020
Data Analysis Intern, Office of Clinical Pharmacology, Food and Drug Administration, 2017

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026: Midwest Economics Association 90th Annual Meeting (Chicago), Grand River Conference (Michigan State University)
2025: Boston College Ph.D. Conference in Economics, Midwest Economics Association 89th Annual Meeting (Kansas City), Red Cedar Conference (Michigan State University)
2024: Midwest Theory Conference (University of Rochester)

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

MSU Student and Faculty Hearing Board, 2026-2027
MSU Economics Graduate Student Organization President, 2025-2026
MSU Economics Graduate Mentor, 2025-2026
MSU Economics Graduate Student Organization Council Member, 2024-2025
MSU Economics Graduate Mentoring Program Coordinator, 2024

REFeree SERVICE

Canadian Journal of Economics

HONORS AND AWARDS

President's Scholarship, University of Maryland, College Park, 2018-2022

Digital Cultures and Creativity Honors Program, University of Maryland, College Park, 2018-2020

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

R, MATLAB, Mathematica, Stata, Java, LaTeX

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: United States

Languages: English (native), Mandarin Chinese (native)

REFERENCES

Jay Pil Choi

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